RIOT LESSON 5: FAULTY THINKING AND WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Understand different kinds of faulty thinking. • Learn some strategies for countering faulty thinking. • Recognise that we can develop unhelpful patterns in our thinking.	**Students will be able to:** • Identify and explain at least three kinds of faulty thinking. • Explain the link between an event, our interpretation and an emotion. • Challenge faulty thinking by 'taking a thought to court'.

EXERCISE 1 COGNITIVE DISTORTIONS OR FAULTY THINKING

Match each kind of faulty thinking to an example. Write the letter next to each one.

Emotional reasoning	
Discounting the positive	
Mind reading	
All or nothing thinking	
Catastrophising	

A. "Everyone in class thinks I'm weird."

B. "I feel stupid, so I must be stupid."

C. "I only passed because the test was easy."

D. "If I don't get full marks, I've failed."

E. "If I get this wrong, my whole year is ruined."

EXERCISE 2 SCENARIOS: CLAUDE

Scenario 1: Claude. Claude's teacher is walking around the classroom checking on student work and Claude has his emails open. The teacher asks Claude to get back to his classwork, without realising Claude was getting a link to the shared research document from his research partner. Claude decides then and there that the teacher hates him.

What is Claude's faulty thinking?

☐ Mind reading

☐ Discounting the positive

☐ Emotional reasoning

EXERCISE 3 SCENARIOS: SARA'S DAD

Scenario 2: Sara's dad. Sara's dad is waiting for her to get home from a party. She is being driven by a friend he knows, but not very well. The curfew is 11pm and it's now 11.30pm. Sara's dad starts panicking and assumes the kids have been in a car accident.

What is Sara's dad's faulty thinking?

☐ All or nothing thinking
☐ Catastrophising
☐ Mind reading

EXERCISE 4 TURNING NEGATIVE THOUGHTS INTO POSITIVE ONES

If you were a friend, what could you say to challenge their thinking? Then write 3 negative thoughts and turn them into more helpful ones.

What could you say to Claude?

Negative thought 1 → more helpful thought

Negative thought 2 → more helpful thought

Negative thought 3 → more helpful thought